

Monday, 22 June 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 28° 18°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 31° 18°	MANCHESTER Overcast 30° 19°	GLASGOW Drizzle 19° 14°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Brace yourselves for a four-day heatwave, as the Met Office extends its amber warning for extreme temperatures across the UK.

Temperatures could soar to 38 degrees Celsius, starting from Monday and lasting right through to Thursday. It's certainly going to be a hot start to the week for many.

WEATHER · UK
- 2

Speculation is mounting in Westminster that Prime Minister Keir Starmer might be considering his resignation.

Reports suggest a shift in mood within government, with growing signs that the Labour leader could be preparing to step down. The political rumour mill is certainly in overdrive.

POLITICS · UK
- 3

Disruption is expected to last for a week in Bedford following Friday's fatal train crash.

Police have confirmed that 28 people remain in hospital after two trains collided. Investigations are continuing into the cause of the tragic incident.

ACCIDENT · UK
- 4

Three men have tragically died following a building fire in White City, London.

The men were rescued from the single-storey building by the London Fire Brigade. However, despite their efforts, all three sadly passed away soon after.

FIRE · UK
- 5

A manslaughter arrest has been made after a migrant was found unresponsive on a small boat crossing the English Channel.

The incident occurred on Saturday, with the individual discovered during the perilous journey. Authorities are investigating the circumstances surrounding the death.

MIGRATION · UK

What's coming up

1

Congratulations are in order for Holly Ramsay and Olympic champion Adam Peaty, who have announced they are expecting their first child!

The happy news comes just six months after Gordon Ramsay's daughter and the swimmer tied the knot in a star-studded ceremony. What wonderful news for the couple!

ON AIR – What's the best piece of advice you could give to new parents?

CELEBRITY BABY · FUTURE

2

Michael Fassbender has shared his concerns about the increasing difficulty of discerning truth from fiction online.

The actor, promoting his new spy thriller 'The Agency', discussed the challenges of espionage in the age of AI. He highlighted how technology makes it harder to know what to trust.

ON AIR – Do you find it harder to trust what you see and read online these days?

FILM · FUTURE

3

Japanese pop group XG have gone from brutal five-year training to global superstardom!

The group were recruited before they were even teenagers and have now become a worldwide sensation. Their journey to fame has been incredibly intense.

ON AIR – What's the most dedicated you've ever been to achieving a goal?

MUSIC · FUTURE

4

The rise of 'real, raw, and unfiltered' female singers is shaking up the music charts.

Artists like Olivia Rodrigo and Olivia Dean are finding huge success with their relatable and authentic styles. It seems honesty is the best policy in pop music right now.

ON AIR – Who are your favourite 'real and relatable' artists in music today?

MUSIC · FUTURE

5

Kim Kardashian's hair stylist, Chris Appleton, has joined the star-studded line-up for this year's Strictly Come Dancing!

The British stylist is renowned for his work with A-list celebrities including Jennifer Lopez and Ariana Grande. He's sure to bring some serious glamour to the dancefloor!

ON AIR – Who are you most excited to see on Strictly this year?

TV · FUTURE

On the schedule

1 **England has suffered a crushing defeat against New Zealand in the second Test, with Matt Henry taking an incredible 11 wickets.**

New Zealand secured a huge 253-run victory, levelling the series after running through England's lower batting order. It was a truly dominant display from Henry and his team.

ON AIR – After such a heavy defeat, what changes do you think England need to make for the next Test?

CRICKET · UK

2 **Amber Anning has clinched the women's 400m title at the UK Athletics Championships with a new record time!**

Meanwhile, an emotional Keely Hodgkinson was forced to withdraw from the final. It was a day of high drama and impressive performances on the track.

ON AIR – What's been your favourite moment from the UK Athletics Championships so far?

ATHLETICS · UK

3 **Zharnel Hughes has stormed to victory in the men's 200m at the UK Athletics Championships, setting a new championship record.**

He finished with an impressive time of 20.04 seconds, showcasing his incredible speed and form. What a performance from the British sprinter!

ON AIR – Which British athlete are you most excited to watch in the coming year?

ATHLETICS · UK

4 **Northampton have claimed their third English title after a compelling Premiership final victory over Exeter.**

The team showed incredible grit and unity to prevail in a hard-fought tussle. It was a truly memorable day for the Saints supporters.

ON AIR – What was the most exciting sporting final you've watched recently?

RUGBY · UK

5 **Marie Bouzkova has overcome an ankle injury to win the Nottingham Open, securing her first grass-court singles title!**

Bouzkova beat Emma Navarro in a tough final, demonstrating incredible resilience. It's a fantastic achievement for the Czech player.

ON AIR – Who are you backing to win Wimbledon this year?

TENNIS · UK

Quick hits

- 1 Good news for early risers: new research suggests a morning cuppa might do more than just wake you up.**
Scientists are exploring how the simple act of brewing and enjoying a hot drink at dawn can boost your mood and set a positive tone for the day ahead, citing a blend of routine and sensory pleasure.
- 2 The humble art of 'doodling' is getting a serious reappraisal.**
It turns out those little scribbles during meetings or phone calls might actually enhance concentration and memory, rather than being a sign of distraction. Who knew our idle drawings were so productive?
- 3 Forget grand gestures, it's the 'tiny treats' that really make us happy, according to a recent lifestyle survey.**
Things like a perfectly brewed tea, finding a forgotten tenner in a coat pocket, or a sunny patch on a cloudy day were cited as significant mood boosters, proving joy often comes in small packages.
- 4 Birdwatching is soaring in popularity, not just in rural areas but also right here in our urban jungles.**
More and more city dwellers are discovering the calming joy of spotting local birds, turning balconies and park benches into prime viewing spots. All you need are keen eyes and a bit of patience!
- 5 Research into 'comfort colours' suggests that specific hues can genuinely make us feel more relaxed and secure.**
Warm blues and gentle greens are often cited as the most soothing, proving that surrounding ourselves with the right shades can be a simple, effective way to boost our well-being.
- 6 The delightful trend of 'afternoon tea' is evolving, with many cafes offering creative twists on this much-loved British tradition.**
Think savoury scones, inventive sandwich fillings, and miniature desserts that are almost too pretty to eat. It's a lovely excuse to catch up and indulge in a bit of everyday luxury.
- 7 There's a growing appreciation for the simple beauty of 'cloud gazing'.**
Experts suggest that taking a few moments to observe the ever-changing shapes in the sky can be a wonderfully mindful activity, helping to reduce stress and spark imagination. Just lie back and look up!

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what with our toast, even if it might be a bit unconventional?

ANSWER: CUTTING IT INTO SPECIFIC, PERHAPS UNUSUAL, SHAPES BEFORE EATING IT!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'song' that we always skip if it comes on, no matter how popular it is?

ANSWER: THAT ONE EARWORM EVERYONE ELSE SEEMS TO LOVE!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes you have a 'little ritual' that you absolutely have to do before you can properly start your day?**
Whether it's a specific order for your morning cuppa, or a particular song you listen to, what's that one thing you just can't skip?

- **We all have those 'unspoken rules' that we live by in our own homes, don't we?**
Things like 'never put the teacup there' or 'always put the remote back on the left'. What are the unique house rules in your abode?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that a group of owls is called a parliament?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that ladybirds are believed to be good luck because they eat garden pests, making them a gardener's best friend?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£7.48 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£7.48 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The 'rewind' button on a remote control was originally called 'backscan'.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time: one hundredth of a second.
- The longest place name in the UK is Llanfairpwllgwyngyllgogerychwyrndrobwl'llantysiliogogogoch, in Wales.
- Bananas are berries, but strawberries are not.
- The first computer mouse was made of wood.
- There are more fake flamingos in the world than real ones.
- The iconic 'red phone box' was designed by Sir Giles Gilbert Scott, who also designed Liverpool Cathedral.
- The human nose can remember 50,000 different scents.

On this day

Day 173 of the year, 192 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Aaron of Aleth; Christian feast day: Alban, first recorded Martyr in Britain (commemoration, Anglicanism); Christian feast day: Blessed Pope Innocent V; Christian feast day: Eusebius of Samosata (Catholic and Eastern Orthodox Church). Star sign Cancer, birthstone Pearl.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1949 — Meryl Streep, American actress
- 1992 — Harry Reid, British actor
- 1962 — Bobby Gillespie, Scottish musician and singer-songwriter
- 1954 — Freddie Prinze, American comedian and actor (died 1977)
- 1964 — Amy Brenneman, American actress
- 1949 — Lindsay Wagner, American actress
- 1944 — Peter Asher, English singer, guitarist, and producer
- 1974 — Donald Faison, American actor

THE DAY TODAY

- 1979 — Former Liberal Party leader Jeremy Thorpe was acquitted of conspiracy to murder Norman Scott, who had accused Thorpe of having a relationship with him.
- 1944 — U.S. President Franklin D. Roosevelt signs into law the Servicemen's Readjustment Act of 1944, commonly known as the G.I. Bill.
- 1966 — Vietnamese Buddhist activist leader Thích Trí Quang was arrested as the military junta of Nguyen Cao Ky crushed the Buddhist Uprising.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2025 — The United States conducts airstrikes on three Iranian nuclear sites in Fordow, Natanz, and Isfahan.
- 1969 — The Cuyahoga River catches fire in Cleveland, Ohio, drawing national attention to water pollution, and spurring the passing of the Clean Water Act and the creation of the Environmental Protection Agency.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1979 — Former Liberal Party leader Jeremy Thorpe was acquitted of conspiracy to murder Norman Scott, who had accused Thorpe of having a relationship with him.

- 1965 — The Treaty on Basic Relations between Japan and the Republic of Korea is signed.
- 2022 — An earthquake occurs in eastern Afghanistan resulting in over 1,000 deaths.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 174 of the year, 191 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Æthelthryth; Christian feast day: Joseph Cafasso; Christian feast day: Blessed Maria Raffaella Cimatti; Christian feast day: Marie of Oignies. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Pearl.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1940 — Adam Faith, English singer (died 2003)
- 1975 — David Howell, English golfer
- 1962 — Chuck Billy, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1969 — Martin Klebba, American actor, producer, and stuntman
- 1940 — Stuart Sutcliffe, Scottish painter and musician (died 1962)
- 1986 — Christy Altomare, American actress and singer-songwriter
- 1929 — June Carter Cash, American singer-songwriter, musician, and actress (died 2003)
- 1972 — Selma Blair, American actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2001 — The 8.4 Mw southern Peru earthquake shakes coastal Peru with a maximum Mercalli intensity of VIII (Severe). A destructive tsunami followed, leaving at least 74 people dead, and 2,687 injured.
- 2013 — Nik Wallenda becomes the first man to successfully walk across the Grand Canyon on a tight rope.
- 2018 — Twelve boys and an assistant coach from a soccer team in Thailand are trapped in a flooding cave, leading to an 18-day rescue operation.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1961 — The Antarctic Treaty System, which sets aside Antarctica as a scientific preserve and limits military activity on the continent, its islands and ice shelves, comes into force.
- 1951 — The ocean liner SS United States is christened and launched.

Coming to cinemas

JUNE 2026	
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life

JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JUNE 2026		JULY 2026	
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
		18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
		23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
		AUGUST 2026	
		W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
		22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)